

Cybersecurity Daily Newsletter

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Top 5 Highlights

- Cops, CrowdStrike disrupt Sality botnet by poisoning the network and diverting into sinkholes
- Cronos network resumes activity after \$74 million lending exploit
- Silver Fox uses adware to distribute ValleyRAT backdoor
- What happens when AI models take aim at ICS exploits
- Cloudflare launches adaptive intelligence to combat bot attacks

Threat Intelligence (10)

01. Cops, CrowdStrike disrupt Sality botnet by poisoning the network and diverting into sinkholes

23-year-old botnet down

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/cyber-crime/2026/09/02/cops-crowdstrike-disrupt-sality-botnet-by-poisoning-the-network-and-diverting-into-sinkholes/5293795>

02. Silver Fox uses adware to distribute ValleyRAT backdoor

As reported by The Hacker News, the threat actor known as Silver Fox is distributing the ValleyRAT backdoor disguised as a signed Chinese adware application.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/silver-fox-uses-adware-to-distribute-valleyrat-backdoor>

03. Cloudflare launches adaptive intelligence to combat bot attacks

The introduction of Adaptive Intelligence addresses the increasing ease and low cost for attackers to rent compromised devices and employ sophisticated impersonation techniques.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/cloudflare-launches-adaptive-intelligence-to-combat-bot-attacks>

04. Counterfeit installers to system compromise: Tracking a deceptive software download campaign

An active campaign is impersonating legitimate software vendors to deliver malware through look-alike download pages and regenerated installer archives. Microsoft Defender Experts shares observed attack techniques, Defender XDR detections, indicators of compromise, and practical mitigations to help organizations identify, block, and respond to this threat....

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/security/blog/2026/09/01/counterfeit-installers-system-compromise-tracking-deceptive-software-download-campaign/>

05. Guildma (Astaroth) malware infection from Brazilian Portuguese email, (Tue, Sep 1st)

Introduction

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://isc.sans.edu/diary/rss/33300>

06. Hackers abuse Faronics Deploy admin tool to install ScreenConnect

Phishing actors are abusing the legitimate Faronics Deploy endpoint-management platform to gain remote administrative control over victim computers and install the ScreenConnect remote support software. [...]

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/hackers-abuse-faronics-deploy-admin-tool-to-install-screenconnect/>

07. Chinese-speaking threat actors targeting Mexican Android users with remote access Trojan

Intel 471 uncovered PanDa, a newly identified Android RAT targeting Spanish-speaking users in Mexico through malicious Meta Ads. The operation leverages AppPanda to scale phishing campaigns and deliver extensive surveillance capabilities.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.intel471.com/blog/chinese-speaking-threat-actors-targeting-mexican-android-users-with-remote-access-trojan>

08. Vishing campaign abuses Microsoft Teams to give attackers a foothold in company networks

A coordinated voice-phishing (vishing) campaign, named Spring Ring, used fake IT support accounts on Microsoft Teams to trick employees into installing malware or granting remote access to their computers, according to Unit 42, Palo Alto Networks' threat intelligence team. The campaign ran between January and April 2026 and reached more than 150 employees a...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/09/01/spring-ring-vishing-campaign-microsoft-teams/>

09. ClickFix Campaign Compromises 31 Orgs, Abuses Polygon Blockchain

The campaign uses EtherHiding to dynamically update its command-and-control server, abusing the blockchain as an attacker-controlled address book.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/endpoint-security/clickfix-campaign-compromises-31-orgs-abuses-polygon-blockchain>

10. Iranian Hackers Pose as Recruiters to Deliver Cross-Platform RATs Through Coding Tests

The Iranian Nimbus Manticore hacking group has been attributed to two previously undocumented malware families that highlight the continued evolution of its toolset and likely expand its targeting footprint to infect Linux and Apple macOS systems using cross-platform remote access trojans (RATs) developed using Node.js and JavaScript. Russian cybersecurity...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/iranian-hackers-pose-as-recruiters-to.html>

Latest Vulnerabilities (10)

01. Cronos network resumes activity after \$74 million lending exploit

The attacker exploited the Tectonic platform, a decentralized finance lending application on the Cronos network, by inflating the price of the TONIC token by 100 times.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/cronos-network-resumes-activity-after-74-million-lending-exploit>

02. What happens when AI models take aim at ICS exploits

LLMs have shown great improvement in vulnerability research and exploit development capabilities over the past six months. But it's one thing to find vulnerabilities in well documented open-source projects and an entirely different skillset to decrypt file systems and reverse-engineer closed-source low-level firmware in highly specialized embedded devices....

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.csoonline.com/article/4217212/what-happens-when-ai-models-take-aim-at-ics-exploits.html>

03. Cryptography expert: AI could make software too secure, impacting government hacking capabilities

Cryptography professor Matthew Green has raised concerns that artificial intelligence could make software so secure that law enforcement and intelligence agencies may lose their ability to lawfully hack criminals, with further coverage provided by TechCrunch.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/ai-could-make-software-too-secure-impacting-government-hacking-capabilities>

04. FBI Probes Service Selling 153M+ Drivers Licenses

A new identity theft service launched on the dark web this week is selling digital scans of more than 153 million drivers licenses from people in the United States and Canada. Based on interviews with individuals whose licenses are available for purchase on this service, it appears to be siphoning images collected by a widely-used identity verification comp...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/09/fbi-probes-service-selling-153m-drivers-licenses/>

05. Attackers Pounce on Critical Artifactory Flaw Following Disclosure

CVE-2026-82329 is an authentication bypass flaw in JFrog's repository manager that enables bad actors to gain admin-level access on affected systems.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.darkreading.com/application-security/attackers-pounce-critical-artifactory-flaw-disclosure>

06. Critical Langflow Flaw Exploited as Attacks on AI Platform Rise

The attacks targeting CVE-2026-0768 are the latest threat against the low-code AI development platform, which is receiving more attention from adversaries this year.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/vulnerabilities-threats/critical-langflow-flaw-exploited-attacks-rise>

07. JFrog Artifactory flaw exploited days after patch release

Attackers exploited a JFrog Artifactory flaw days after its patch, threatening software supply chains.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/news/jfrog-artifactory-flaw-exploited-days-after-patch-release>

08. Critical Langflow flaw exploited to steal OpenAI and AWS keys

Threat actors are exploiting an unauthenticated remote code execution vulnerability (CVE-2026-0768) in Langflow, an open-source framework for building AI applications, to steal credentials, tokens, and keys. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/critical-langflow-flaw-exploited-to-steal-open-ai-and-aws-keys/>

09. Attackers Exploit Critical JFrog Artifactory Flaw to Mint Admin Tokens Days After Disclosure

Threat actors are exploiting a newly patched critical security flaw impacting JFrog Artifactory merely days after public disclosure, according to watchTower. The vulnerability in question is CVE-2026-82329 (CVSS score: 9.8), a case of authentication bypass that could lead to administrative access in Artifactory. "JFrog Artifactory contains an authentication...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/attackers-exploit-critical-jfrog.html>

10. Breeze Comet Executes Hundreds of Fraudulent Transactions via Brazilian Payment Systems

Brazilian financial services, retail, and e-commerce organizations have become the target of a financially motivated threat actor dubbed Breeze Comet (formerly UNC5669) since 2024. Google Threat Intelligence Group (GTIG) and Mandiant teams described the threat

actor as "specializing in manipulating payment systems and banking software in Brazil to conduct f...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/breeze-comet-executes-hundreds-of.html>

Data Breach & Cybercrime (10)

01. Stronger Security Drives Ransomware Groups to Recruit From Within

Some security researchers have observed an uptick in insider-assisted ransomware attacks, but malicious insiders pose other threats that cost companies millions.

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cyber-risk/stronger-security-drives-ransomware-groups-to-recruit-from-within>

02. Aesto Health says data breach affects over 9.5 million patients

Aesto LLC, operating as Aesto Health, disclosed that a data breach discovered recently affects more than 9.5 million individuals. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/aesto-health-says-data-breach-affects-over-95-million-patients/>

03. CrowdStrike launches cyber frontier AI models, agentic security system

CrowdStrike today announced SafeMind, a cybersecurity-specific AI model-harness system that CEO George Kurtz described as the "first complete agentic system for cybersecurity" at the company's Fal.Con conference in Las Vegas. At the heart of SafeMind are two purpose-built cybersecurity models, the adversarial Red Tempest and the defensive Blue Solano. Both...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4217135/crowdstrike-launches-cyber-frontier-ai-models-agentic-security-system.html>

04. Fake GTA 6 leaked copy drains your crypto wallet

A fake GTA 6 leak is using wallet-draining code to steal cryptocurrency, tokens, and NFTs from eager fans.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources:

<https://www.malwarebytes.com/blog/scams/2026/09/fake-gta-6-leaked-copy-drains-your-crypto-wallet>

05. Attackers Steal METR API Key and Burn \$600,000 in AI Credits

Attackers used a stolen METR API key for three weeks, consuming model credits worth \$600,000

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/attackers-steal-metr-api-key/>

06. Novocure data breach affects more than 1,400 cancer patients

Healthtech company Novocure says the data of an undisclosed number of employees and more than 1,400 U.S. cancer patients has been exposed in a mid-August cyberattack. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/novocure-data-breach-affects-more-than-1-400-cancer-patients/>

07. Ransomware Gang Claims Nutex Health Data Breach

The company has notified the SEC that hackers accessed patient, employee, provider, business, and financial information. The post Ransomware Gang Claims Nutex Health Data Breach appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/ransomware-gang-claims-nutex-health-data-breach/>

08. [+24h Old] 9.5 Million Impacted by Aesto Health Data Breach

Hackers stole personal and health information from the healthcare technology company's AWS infrastructure. The post 9.5 Million Impacted by Aesto Health Data Breach appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/9-5-million-impacted-by-aesto-health-data-breach/>

09. [+24h Old] Berlin refuses to be blackmailed after network breach

Berlin's state government has confirmed an extortion attempt following a data theft from its administrative network in August. Governing Mayor Kai Wegner and Interior Senator Iris Spranger addressed the extortion attempt on Friday, following an emergency Senate session at the Rotes Rathaus. "The state of Berlin is being blackmailed," Wegner said. "Berlin ha...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/09/01/berlin-data-breach-rhysida-ransomware/>

10. [+24h Old] Healthcare Giant McKesson Investigates Data Breach Incident

ShinyHunters claims to have stolen 284 million records from McKesson

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/healthcare-mckesson-investigates/>